Week 10: Speaking, Presentations and Nervousness

NPTEL Soft Skills · Prof. Binod Mishra · Lectures 46–50

Contents

1. Lecture 46: Advanced Speaking Skills
2. Lecture 47: Oral Presentations, Speeches, and Debates
3. Lecture 48: Combating Nervousness
4. Lecture 49: Patterns and Methods of Presentation
5. Lecture 50: Oral Presentation: Planning & Preparation

Lecture 46: Advanced Speaking Skills

Week 10 · Course book PDF pages 750–767 (printed pages 749–766)

Learning objectives

- Explain why speaking is a skill and how it differs from writing.
- List the situations where speaking is required.
- State the advantages of speaking over writing.
- Describe the four components of effective speaking: voice, vocabulary, audience, style.
- Recall the quotations by Shakespeare and Benjamin Franklin.

Important definitions

LSRW

Listening, Speaking, Reading, Writing: the four language skills; this lecture covers ‘S’.

SPEAKING SKILL

The ability to perform tasks (convince, inform, report, entertain) by spoken words coupled with non-verbal communication.

CONVERSATION

An art of informal two-way speaking, e.g. breaking the ice with a co-passenger.

SPONTANEITY

Natural, unplanned quality of speech that keeps the audience engaged.

STYLE (IN SPEAKING)

The speaker's inner voice: animation, enthusiasm and audibility.

AUDIBILITY

Being heard clearly even by the last row.

Core concepts

Why speaking is a skill

- Speaking is natural, but in organisations tasks are communication-based; a professional must master all LSRW skills.
- Individually you must convince, prove, satisfy, report, inform and entertain (as employee, manager or CEO).
- A silent person in a group is seen as uninterested or without content.
- Verbal communication is coupled with **non-verbal** cues.

Situations requiring speaking

- Conversation, meetings, negotiations, group discussions, debates.
- Speeches and presentations; giving or taking interviews.
- Oral presentations; talks with several people for an MOU.

Advantages of speaking over writing

- **Face to face:** immediate feedback and reading the listener's reaction.
- Allows **clarification**, dialogue and persuasion.
- Builds **credibility and rapport**; more energising than reading.
- **Emotion** conveyed through voice (commentary on cricket versus silent TV).
- Clearer, more lucid, explanatory and **spontaneous**; reliable because of expressions.
- **Saves time**; quick response; flexible tone and tenor (anger, sadness, joy, favour, instruction).
- Voice can be modulated (also can be manipulated, as actors do).

Four components of effective speaking

1. **Voice** – God's gift but the way of speaking can be trained (singers train pitch); aim at clarity; avoid too fast (may signal fear) or too slow.
2. **Vocabulary** – enriched over years; must use right words in the right place; words are context-based (e.g. 'recycle' for a computer person versus a pharmacist); use familiar words.
3. **Audience** – know age, background, taste, gender and education; if unknown, imagine a mixed gathering; size affects enthusiasm.
4. **Style** – enthusiasm and animation; audibility to the last row (check microphone); a vibrant start and varied tone, never monotone.

Quotations

- "Half the world is full of people who have nothing to say and keep saying on; the other half has too much to say yet cannot say it."

- **Shakespeare:** men of few words are the best men.
- **Benjamin Franklin:** "Remember not only to say the right thing in the right place, but far more difficult still, to leave unsaid the wrong thing at the tempting moment."
- Every speaker wins or loses in the beginning.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Components of effective speaking

Component	Key idea
Voice	Trainable; clarity; modulation
Vocabulary	Right word, right place; familiar words
Audience	Know and adapt
Style	Enthusiasm, audibility, variety

Speaking situations

Situation	Example
Informal	Conversation
Group	Meeting, GD, debate, negotiation
Formal solo	Speech, presentation
Interview	Giving or taking

Theories, principles, models and contributors

RIGHT WORD, RIGHT TIME — BENJAMIN FRANKLIN

It is more difficult to leave unsaid the wrong thing at the tempting moment than to say the right thing in the right place.

MEN OF FEW WORDS — WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE (AS CITED)

Men of few words are the best men.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Cricket commentary versus a silent television.

EXAMPLE

Breaking the ice with a co-passenger on a train.

EXAMPLE

Word ‘recycle’ in computing versus pharmacy.

EXAMPLE

Speaking to a half-empty versus full class.

Comparison tables

Speaking versus writing

Point	Speaking	Writing
Time	Quick	Slower, can be delayed
Feedback	Immediate	Delayed
Non-verbal cues	Present	Absent
Emotion	Conveyed by voice	Limited
Permanence	Fleeting (unless recorded)	Permanent record

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- LSRW: this lecture is on speaking.
- Four components: voice, vocabulary, audience, style.
- Voice can be trained; the quality itself is a gift.
- Use familiar words.
- Know your audience; imagine a mixed audience if unknown.
- Speakers win or lose at the start.
- Audibility to the last row is essential.
- Speaking can be modulated and even manipulated.
- Franklin quotation on leaving unsaid the wrong thing.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W10 Q1	p.34	Speaking skills	MCQ
W10 Q2	p.34	Importance of advanced speaking skills	MCQ
W10 Q3	p.34	Components of effective speaking	MCQ
W10 Q11	p.36	Advanced speaking skills	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Speaking is a skill that complements writing: it is fast, face to face, emotive and spontaneous, builds rapport and credibility, and gives immediate feedback. It is needed in conversation, meetings, negotiations, GDs, debates, speeches, presentations and interviews. Effective speaking rests on four components – voice (trainable), vocabulary (familiar, context-appropriate), audience (know and adapt) and style (enthusiasm, audibility, variety). Franklin: leaving unsaid the wrong thing at the tempting moment is harder than saying the right thing.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) How many components of effective speaking does the lecture list?

A. Two

B. Three

C. Four

D. Five

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Voice, vocabulary, audience, style.

Q2 (MCQ) The advantage of speaking over writing is:

A. Permanent record

B. Immediate feedback

C. More time to edit

D. Less emotion

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Face-to-face feedback.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are speaking situations?

A. Interview

B. Negotiation

C. Presentation

D. Memo writing

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** A memo is written.

Q4 (T/F) A speaker should use difficult words to impress the audience.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Use familiar words.

Q5 Fill Every speaker wins or loses in the _____.

> **Answer:** beginning
> **Why:** First impression matters.

Q6 Short How can voice be improved?

> **Answer:** Voice quality is a gift but one can change the way one speaks through consistent training, clarity, modulation and practice, as singers do.
> **Why:** Aim for clarity and variety.

Revision checklist

☐ I can explain why speaking is a skill.
☐ I know speaking situations.
☐ I can list advantages over writing.
☐ I can name four components.
☐ I recall Franklin.

Lecture 47: Oral Presentations, Speeches, and Debates

Week 10 · Course book PDF pages 768–783 (printed pages 767–782)

Learning objectives

- Define oral presentation, speech and debate and differentiate them.
- List occasions for oral presentations.
- Explain the role of visual aids and the question–answer session.
- Describe the purposes and features of speeches.
- State how to prepare for and deliver a debate, including rebuttal and courtesy (Roosevelt).

Important definitions

ORAL PRESENTATION

A planned, factual, professional talk to a small, defined audience to inform or persuade, usually with visual aids and a question–answer session leading to a decision.

SPEECH

Formal face-to-face oral communication to an audience for a purpose, relying on voice, vocabulary, gesture and posture, usually without visual aids.

DEBATE

A formal contest of arguments on a motion, with speakers for or against, requiring research, logic and rebuttal.

VISUAL AIDS

Charts, graphs, tables, film clips and live demonstrations used in presentations.

BRIEFING

A short presentation to update a group (press, vendors, senior executives).

REBUTTAL

The time to counter the opponent’s arguments.

ORIENTATION PROGRAMME

A presentation introducing new members to an organisation or course.

Core concepts

Purposes of speaking

All speaking situations aim to **inform**, **persuade** or **entertain**.

Oral presentation

- Given to a **small defined group**; more challenging because they listen to every word.
- Factual and not too emotional; **informative or persuasive**.
- Uses **visual aids** – charts, graphs, tables, film clips, live demo – to satisfy curiosity.
- Leads to a decision (e.g. a paperless office, biometric attendance).
- **Question–answer session**: anticipate questions and prepare answers; convince the audience.

Occasions for presentations

- **Budget presentation** for a department/unit.
- **Briefing**: the press, vendors, senior executives (progress updates).
- **Training and orientation** of new employees, students, teachers.
- **Recruitment** tips by placement officers.
- **Launching a new product** and competing with others.

Speech

- Occasions: degree ceremonies, Bhavan day, farewell, impromptu announcements; may inform, persuade or entertain.
- Fear comes from unfamiliar crowds and lack of preparation.
- Uses voice, vocabulary, style, gesture and posture.
- Difference from presentation: speeches generally have **no visual aids** and the audience is usually larger.

Debate: value and skills

- Builds **argumentative ability** and **critical thinking** (analysis, evaluation, conceptualisation).
- Two sides: for or against the motion; opinion must be backed by logic and data.
- Enriches speaking and arguing skills; topics may be literal, psychological, quotations, etc.

Preparing for a debate

1. **Research** the topic (not only Google) and collect data.
2. Draft the speech with conviction; use arguments supported by facts.
3. **Rehearse** several times with a guide.
4. Listen carefully to the opposition and prepare to counter.
5. Use **note cards** that are legible.
6. Use **rebuttal time** well – it can change the result.

On the day of the debate

- Reach the venue **well in time**; be mentally, physically and psychologically ready.
- Treat opponents with courtesy; greet panelists.
- Use appropriate non-verbal behaviour; polite, harmless language even when contradicting.

- **Roosevelt:** “Courtesy is as much a mark of a gentleman as courage.”

Types, classifications and characteristics

Occasions for oral presentations

Occasion	Audience
Budget presentation	Colleagues, management
Press briefing	Media
Vendor briefing	Vendors
Executive briefing	Senior executives
Training/orientation	New recruits, students, teachers
Product launch	Team, customers

Debate preparation

Step	Detail
Research	Collect facts and data
Draft	Logical arguments
Rehearse	Practise delivery
Listen	Note opposing points
Rebuttal	Counter effectively

Theories, principles, models and contributors

COURTESY AND COURAGE — THEODORE ROOSEVELT (AS CITED)

Courtesy is as much a mark of a gentleman as courage.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Biometric attendance replacing registers.

EXAMPLE

Budget presentation to colleagues.

EXAMPLE

Impromptu announcement of a student’s name on Bhavan day.

EXAMPLE

Rebuttal turning the result.

Comparison tables

Presentation, speech and debate

Point	Oral presentation	Speech	Debate
Audience	Small, defined	Usually larger	Judges and audience
Aim	Inform/persuade; decision	Inform, persuade, entertain	Win by argument
Visual aids	Yes	Usually no	Note cards only
Tone	Factual, less emotional	Occasion-based	Argumentative, logical
Q&A	Yes	Not necessarily	Rebuttal

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Speaking aims to inform, persuade or entertain.
- Oral presentations suit small defined groups and use visual aids.
- Prepare for the Q&A by anticipating questions.
- Briefings: press, vendors, senior executives.
- Speeches normally lack visual aids.
- Debate develops argumentative ability and critical thinking.
- Rebuttal time can decide the winner.
- Reach the debate venue early.
- Roosevelt: courtesy is as much a mark of a gentleman as courage.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W10 Q5	p.34	Debate	MCQ
W10 Q6	p.35	Speeches	MCQ
W10 Q12	p.36	Types of presentation	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Speaking serves to inform, persuade or entertain. An oral presentation is a planned, factual talk to a small defined audience, using visual aids and ending with a question–answer session that leads to decisions; occasions include budgets, briefings, training and product launches. A speech is a formal

oral address to a larger audience for an occasion, usually without visual aids. A debate develops argumentative ability and critical thinking and requires research, rehearsal, careful listening, effective rebuttal and courtesy.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) An oral presentation is typically given to:

A. A huge crowd

B. A small defined group

C. A single reader

D. No one

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Small groups listen carefully.

Q2 (MCQ) Rebuttal in a debate means:

A. Opening the motion

B. Countering opponent's arguments

C. Thanking the judge

D. Summarising the topic

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Time to counter points.

Q3 (MSQ) Visual aids used in presentations include:

A. Charts

B. Graphs

C. Film clips

D. Live demonstration

> **Answer:** A, B, C, D
> **Why:** All are aids.

Q4 (T/F) Speeches usually involve visual aids more than presentations.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Presentations use visual aids.

Q5 (Fill) Debates cultivate _____ thinking.

> **Answer:** critical
> **Why:** Analysis and evaluation.

Q6 Short Why prepare for the question–answer session?

> **Answer:** Because the audience must be convinced before a decision; anticipating questions and answers helps persuasion.
> **Why:** Q&A decides acceptance.

Revision checklist

☐ I can distinguish presentation, speech, debate.
☐ I know occasions for presentations.
☐ I can prepare for the Q&A.
☐ I know debate preparation steps.
☐ I recall Roosevelt's quote.

Lecture 48: Combating Nervousness

Week 10 · Course book PDF pages 784–799 (printed pages 783–798)

Learning objectives

- Define nervousness and describe its physical and psychological symptoms.
- Explain why nervousness is natural, universal and useful.
- Recall the views of William James, Sartre, Dale Carnegie and Shakespeare.
- List causes of nervousness and their remedies.
- Apply stress busters during a talk.

Important definitions

NERVOUSNESS

A psychological and physiological state of anxiety/fear about performance, with cognitive, emotional and physical components.

AROUSAL

The keyed-up state caused by adrenaline surge in the body.

ADRENALINE SURGE

Release of adrenaline that speeds the heartbeat and breathing and pumps extra energy.

FIGHT OR FLIGHT

Psychologists' term for the response to threat; the speaker should 'fight' nervousness.

STRESS BUSTERS

Techniques such as deep breathing, pausing and speaking slowly to control nerves.

RAPPORT

Friendly connection built with the audience.

Core concepts

Symptoms

- Butterflies and a sinking feeling in the stomach.
- Dry throat, trembling hands, quivering voice.
- Rapid heartbeat and fast speech; forgetting lines.
- Feeling is mostly internal; the audience rarely notices.

Why people feel nervous

- Fear of not performing well; concern about **image** before strangers.
- Unfamiliar audience, unfamiliar or difficult topic, poor preparation, inexperience.
- Survey cited: 80 per cent of people prefer death to public speaking.
- Common to speakers, musicians, singers, cricketers, swimmers.

Nervousness is natural and useful

- **Natural and universal** – even celebrities and experienced speakers feel it.
- You are **more conscious** because you want to perform better.
- **William James:** survival devices prepare us for an emergency – muscles tense for agility, heartbeat and breathing quicken, glands sharpen senses and give emergency energy.
- It is **energising** and improves the talk; fears pass after the opening.
- Analogy: a new Test batsman's nerves vanish after the first ball; crossing a bridge carefully.
- **Sartre:** people have a choice whether to be cowards.
- **Dale Carnegie:** "I am OK, you are OK." The audience will not attack you; worst case, the talk is not appreciated and you learn.
- **Shakespeare:** "Cowards die many times before their death; the valiant taste of death but once."

Remedies before the talk

- **Prepare well in advance** – the best antidote or panacea.
- **Know the audience** (age, education) and use examples from their field.
- Begin with **familiar topics**; research thoroughly.
- Practise before friends in small groups and take feedback.
- **Record yourself** on a cell phone (audio/video) to review body language, pauses and accent.
- **Check the venue** – acoustics, microphone, seating.
- Treat the audience as friends; see their smiles and whispers as compliments.

Stress busters during the talk

- Face the crowd: stand, **pause** and build rapport before the first word.
- Take a **deep breath**; start with a pause, not a verbal firework.
- Speak **slowly and distinctly**; experienced speakers keep a steady pace (slow and steady wins the race).
- If you forget, **review** the last point; the next thought will come.
- Concentrate on the topic, not on shaking hands; a dais hides trembling.
- Tell yourself: 'bear it, not fear it'.
- Fear is in the mind; practise; learn from failures and imitate good speakers.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Symptoms of nervousness

Type	Symptoms
Physical	Dry throat, trembling, fast heartbeat, butterflies
Voice	Quivering, fast speech
Cognitive	Forgetting, worry about image
Emotional	Anxiety, arousal

Causes and remedies

Cause	Remedy
Poor preparation	Prepare well in advance
Unknown audience	Research audience; treat as friends
Difficult topic	Start with familiar topics
Inexperience	Practise in small groups; record yourself
Venue worries	Check venue in advance
Forgetting	Review and pause

Theories, principles, models and contributors

SURVIVAL DEVICES — WILLIAM JAMES

Nervousness is part of survival: the body prepares for emergency with energy.

I AM OK, YOU ARE OK — DALE CARNEGIE (AS CITED)

Tell yourself you and the audience are fine.

CHOICE TO BE COWARD — JEAN-PAUL SARTRE

People choose whether they are cowards.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

New Test batsman facing bouncers.

EXAMPLE

Crossing a bridge cautiously.

EXAMPLE

Recording a talk on a cell phone.

EXAMPLE

80% prefer death to public speaking.

Comparison tables

Experienced versus inexperienced speaker

Point	Experienced	Inexperienced
Pace	Slow and steady	Fast
Start	Pause, then speak	Rushes
Nerves	Controls them	Overwhelmed

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Nervousness is natural and universal.
- It is energising because of adrenaline.
- 80 per cent prefer death to public speaking (survey cited).
- William James: survival devices.
- Preparation is the best antidote.
- Begin with familiar topics.
- Record yourself on a cell phone.
- Pause and breathe before starting.
- Check the venue in advance.
- Shakespeare: cowards die many times.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W10 Q7	p.35	Combating nervousness	MCQ
W10 Q8	p.35	Causes of nervousness	MCQ
W10 Q13	p.36	Anxiety and nervousness	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Nervousness is a natural, universal psychological and physiological response – dry throat, trembling, quivering voice, rapid heartbeat – caused by concern for one's image and unfamiliarity. It is useful because adrenaline gives extra energy (William James). Control it through thorough preparation, knowing the audience, starting with familiar topics, rehearsing and recording yourself, checking the venue, treating the audience as friends, pausing and breathing before speaking, speaking slowly, and reviewing if you forget. Fear is in the mind: bear it, not fear it.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The best antidote to nervousness is:

A. Speaking fast

B. Preparation

C. Avoiding the audience

D. Silence

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Preparation is the panacea.

Q2 (MCQ) Who said survival devices prepare us for an emergency?

A. William James

B. Orwell

C. Tuckman

D. Gunning

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Psychologist William James.

Q3 (MSQ) Stress busters include:

A. Deep breath

B. Starting with a pause

C. Speaking slowly

D. Speaking fast

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Fast speaking signals nervousness.

Q4 (T/F) Nervousness always harms a speaker's performance.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It is energising and natural.

Q5 Fill The keyed-up state caused by adrenaline is called _____.

> **Answer:** arousal
> **Why:** A psychological term.

Q6 Short What should you do if you forget a point?

> **Answer:** Review what you have said; repeating helps the audience and the next thought comes back.
> **Why:** Nothing disastrous will happen.

Revision checklist

☐ I know the symptoms.
☐ I know nervousness is natural.
☐ I can list causes and remedies.
☐ I know stress busters.
☐ I recall James, Sartre, Carnegie.

Lecture 49: Patterns and Methods of Presentation

Week 10 · Course book PDF pages 800–813 (printed pages 799–812)

Learning objectives

- List the 5 Ps of presentations and the three stages of a presentation.
- Describe the five patterns: chronological, causal, problem–solution, spatial, topical.
- Describe the four methods of delivery: manuscript, memorised, impromptu, extemporaneous.
- Evaluate the advantages and limitations of each method.
- Recall the Shakespeare quotations used.

Important definitions

5 PS

Preparation, Planning, Practice, Pattern, Performance.

CHRONOLOGICAL PATTERN

Arranges material in time sequence, e.g. history of civilisation.

CAUSAL PATTERN

Presents causes first and then effects (cause–effect relationship); informative.

PROBLEM–SOLUTION PATTERN

Presents a problem (e.g. deforestation, pollution, global warming) and then offers solutions; persuasive.

SPATIAL PATTERN

Arranged by space or direction, e.g. design of a new product.

TOPICAL PATTERN

Divides information into topics and sub-topics; easiest when others do not fit.

READING FROM MANUSCRIPT

Delivering a written text word for word.

MEMORISED METHOD

Delivering a fully memorised text.

IMPROMPTU METHOD

Unprepared speech given on the spur of the moment.

EXTEMPORANEOUS METHOD

Flexible, prepared with notes/outline/slides, delivered conversationally.

Core concepts

5 Ps and stages

- **5 Ps:** preparation, planning, practice, pattern, performance.
- **Three stages:** pre-presentation, during presentation, post-presentation.
- Preparation is the best antidote to nervousness (fight or flight).

Five patterns of presentation

1. **Chronological** – time sequence, historical events.
2. **Causal** – causes then effects (e.g. causes and effects of nervousness).
3. **Problem–solution** – problem then solution; persuasive.
4. **Spatial** – space or direction, product design.
5. **Topical** – topics and sub-topics; easiest.

Choose according to topic and information.

Reading from manuscript

- **Advantages:** accuracy, suitable for technical or data-heavy subjects, carefully drafted words.
- **Limitations:** no eye contact or rapport; no control over crowd; hard to be spontaneous; strain on eyes; little vocal variety (modulation, pauses); time limit pressure (“Damocles’ sword”); needs a practised reader; audience loses interest.
- Not advisable for beginners.

Memorised method

- Looks fresh and allows eye contact.
- Problems: cannot memorise pauses, shifts in voice or transitions; speed and time control (may finish early); sounds like a robot; **forgetting a part halts the talk**; hard to prepare and sustain.

Impromptu method

- No preparation: on the spot (name announced suddenly).
- Challenging but rewarding; relies on **past reading, experience and observations**.
- Be **brief and to the point**; take a moment, pick a keyword; summarise when ideas run out; resist the temptation to add; silence is better than saying nothing.
- Be mentally prepared always.
- **Shakespeare:** ‘It is best to speak few than to speak more’; ‘There is nothing either good or bad, but thinking makes it so.’

Extemporaneous method

- Prepared flexibly: prepare **more material than needed**; use notes, slides and visual aids; **outline** ready so you can skip.
- Conversational and interactive; gauge the audience's mood and cut or squeeze points.
- Needs expertise.
- A speech may sound conversational but is not a conversation.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Patterns of presentation

Pattern	Basis	Example
Chronological	Time	History of civilisation
Causal	Cause → effect	Nervousness
Problem–solution	Problem → remedy	Deforestation, pollution
Spatial	Space / direction	Product design
Topical	Topics and sub-topics	General information

Methods of delivery

Method	Strength	Weakness
Manuscript	Accurate	No rapport; monotone
Memorised	Fresh, eye contact	Forgetting; robotic
Impromptu	Spontaneous, rewarding	No preparation
Extemporaneous	Flexible, interactive	Needs expertise and outline

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Presentation on deforestation, soil erosion or global warming (problem–solution).

EXAMPLE

Design of a new product (spatial).

EXAMPLE

Name suddenly announced at a function (impromptu).

Comparison tables

Causal versus problem–solution

Point	Causal	Problem–solution
Content	Causes and effects	Problem and remedies
Nature	Informative	Persuasive

Impromptu versus extemporaneous

Point	Impromptu	Extemporaneous
Preparation	None	Prepared with notes/outline
Flexibility	On the spur of the moment	Planned flexibility
Material	Past knowledge	More material than needed

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- 5 Ps: preparation, planning, practice, pattern, performance.
- Three stages: pre, during, post-presentation.
- Five patterns: chronological, causal, problem–solution, spatial, topical.
- Four methods: manuscript, memorised, impromptu, extemporaneous.
- Manuscript reading limits eye contact.
- Memorised talks fail when a part is forgotten.
- Impromptu: be brief.
- Extemporaneous: prepare more than needed; use outline.
- Topical is the easiest pattern.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W10 Q14	p.36	Methods of presentation	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Presentations are built on the 5 Ps and go through pre-, during and post-presentation stages. They may follow a chronological, causal, problem–solution, spatial or topical pattern. Delivery methods are reading from manuscript (accurate but lifeless), memorised (fresh but risky), impromptu (unprepared, brief, relies on experience) and extemporaneous (flexible, conversational, with outline and notes). Beginners should avoid reading and memorising; speaking extemporaneously with an outline is most effective.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which pattern arranges content by time sequence?

A. Spatial

B. Topical

C. Chronological

D. Causal

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Time and events.

Q2 (MCQ) Which method uses an outline and prepares more material than required?

A. Manuscript

B. Memorised

C. Impromptu

D. Extemporaneous

> **Answer:** D
> **Why:** Flexible method.

Q3 (MSQ) Limitations of reading from a manuscript include:

A. No rapport

B. Eye strain

C. Little vocal variety

D. Perfect spontaneity

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Spontaneity is lost.

Q4 (T/F) An impromptu speech should be long to impress the audience.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Be brief and to the point.

Q5 (Fill) The pattern that divides information into topics and sub-topics is _____.

> **Answer:** topical
> **Why:** Easiest to use.

Q6 (Short) Why is the memorised method risky?

> **Answer:** Forgetting one phrase can halt the talk; pauses and transitions are hard to memorise; speed is hard to control and delivery sounds robotic.
> **Why:** Not advisable for novices.

Revision checklist

☐ I know the 5 Ps.
☐ I can name five patterns.
☐ I can name four methods.
☐ I know the limits of manuscript and memorised.
☐ I know how to handle impromptu.

Lecture 50: Oral Presentation: Planning & Preparation

Week 10 · Course book PDF pages 814–831 (printed pages 813–830)

Learning objectives

- Plan an oral presentation: purpose, topic, audience analysis, research, specific purpose statement.
- Prepare content that is audience-specific and written to be spoken.
- Structure the presentation into introduction, body and conclusion with time proportions.
- Plan visual aids, repetition, signposts and anticipated questions.
- Choose topics through an inventory and brainstorming.

Important definitions

PURPOSE STATEMENT

A specific statement of what the talk aims to do: add knowledge, persuade, inform of trends.

AUDIENCE ANALYSIS

Studying the age, background, education, faith, gender and interests of the listeners.

AUDIENCE-SPECIFIC CONTENT

Content designed to benefit the particular audience.

VERBATIM

Word for word, as in a full manuscript.

INVENTORY OF TOPICS

A personal record of topics and new information kept for future talks.

SIGNPOSTS / TRANSFER STATIONS

Transitions and previews that guide the audience through the talk.

CALL FOR ACTION

A closing appeal in problem–solution talks urging the audience to act.

Core concepts

Planning sequence

1. Know the **purpose**: why, whom and how.

2. Decide the **topic** (given by host or chosen by you).
3. **Analyse the audience**.
4. **Research** and gather information.
5. Formulate a **specific purpose statement**.
6. Prepare **content** and visual aids.
7. Divide into **beginning, middle, end**.
8. Plan for questions and practise.

Choosing the topic

- Pick a topic **familiar to you** (reduces nervousness) but add something new for the audience.
- Keep an **inventory** of topics of interest from school/college days; update it continuously (library, internet).
- **Brainstorm** about the audience's tastes, habits, interests, beliefs.
- Mix the new and the old: familiarity increases receptivity.

Audience analysis

- Many good presentations fail because the speaker did not understand the audience.
- Consider age, background, education, faith, gender, rural/urban, profession; mixed gatherings are common.
- Make the talk beneficial to them.

Preparing the content

- Good content matters more than a good voice.
- Write for the ear: compose word by word (manuscript method) but keep it spoken.
- **Short sentences** that speak; suitable, simple words; avoid jargon, clichés, circumlocution, idioms and phrases for second-language audiences.
- Use **repetition** and summarising (e.g. Martin Luther King's 'I have a dream').
- Insert transitions and signposts; plan places for pauses and shifts.

Visual aids

- Use for technical subjects; pictures aid understanding.
- Decide in advance **where** each aid will appear and mark it in the outline.
- Make aids relevant, specific and accessible; avoid merely catchy ones.

Three parts: beginning, middle, end

- **Introduction** – capture attention (quote, anecdote, story, e.g. Nehru's 'Tryst with destiny'); state purpose; preview main points; build credibility and rapport. About **2 minutes of a 20-minute talk**; do not make it long.
- **Body** – the heart of the matter; limit to **two or three points**, each explained and supported; simple, logical, stepwise.
- **Conclusion** – inference from the body; **restate and recapitulate** so the audience carries something home; call for action in problem–solution talks; signal the end ('to conclude…'); avoid an abrupt or limp ending.

Questions and notes

- Encourage questions; anticipate them and prepare answers.
- Prepare more material than required but be ready to skip.
- Note cards with legible keywords; leave space in the script to look up at the audience.
- Use quotations and references for support; create animation through word choice.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Structure of a presentation

Part	Role	Guidance
Introduction	Capture attention; preview	About 10% of time; quote, anecdote, story
Body	Develop 2–3 points	Logical, supported, simple
Conclusion	Recapitulate; call for action	Natural signal to end; invite questions

Planning checklist

Step	Question to ask
Purpose	Why am I speaking and to whom?
Topic	Is it familiar and useful to them?
Audience	Age, background, education?
Content	Are sentences short and spoken?
Aids	Where will each be used?
Questions	What will they ask?

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Martin Luther King’s repetition ‘I have a dream’.

EXAMPLE

Nehru’s ‘Tryst with destiny’ opening.

EXAMPLE

Presentation on modern cell phones adding special new information.

EXAMPLE

20-minute talk with a 2-minute introduction.

Comparison tables

Good versus poor introduction

Point	Good	Poor
Opening	Quote, anecdote, story	Long, dull background
Length	About 10% of time	Excessively long
Effect	Captures attention, rapport	Loses audience

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Planning starts with purpose, topic and audience.
- Speak on a familiar topic and add new information.
- Maintain an inventory of topics.
- Write short sentences meant to be spoken.
- Repetition helps (Martin Luther King).
- Decide positions of visual aids in the outline.
- Three parts: beginning, body, end.
- Introduction ≈ 2 minutes in a 20-minute talk.
- Restrict body to two or three points.
- Conclusion restates and may call for action.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W10 Q9	p.35	Prerequisites of an oral presentation	MCQ
W10 Q10	p.35	Selecting a topic	MCQ
W10 Q15	p.36	Audience analysis	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Plan an oral presentation by fixing the purpose, selecting a familiar yet fresh topic (using an inventory and brainstorming), analysing the audience and researching. Draft audience-specific content in short, simple, spoken sentences with repetition, signposts and planned visual aids. Structure it into a brief attention-grabbing introduction, a body of two or three well-supported points and a conclusion that recapitulates and, if needed, calls for action. Anticipate questions, prepare notes and extra material, and then practise.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) In a 20-minute talk, the introduction should take about:

A. 2 minutes

B. 10 minutes

C. 15 minutes

D. 5 minutes after the body

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Do not make it long.

Q2 (MCQ) How many main points should the body ideally have?

A. Two or three

B. Ten

C. Fifteen

D. As many as possible

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** Avoid overload.

Q3 (MSQ) Good ways to open a presentation:

A. Quotation

B. Anecdote

C. Story

D. Apology for being unprepared

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Capture attention.

Q4 (T/F) A speech written to be spoken should use long, complex sentences.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Use short sentences that speak.

Q5 (Fill) Keeping an _____ of topics helps in impromptu situations.

> **Answer:** inventory
> **Why:** Update it regularly.

Q6 (Short) What should the conclusion contain?

> **Answer:** An inference from the body, a restatement or recapitulation of main points, a call for action if relevant, and a natural signal that the talk is ending.
> **Why:** Avoid abrupt endings.

Revision checklist

☐ I can plan purpose, topic, audience.
☐ I know how to write for the ear.
☐ I know where to place visual aids.
☐ I can structure the three parts.
☐ I can anticipate questions.